Before the Negotiation:

1. **Research thoroughly** - Know the market rate for your role, experience level, and location using sites like Glassdoor, Linkedin Salary, and industry reports. This gives you concrete data to support your position.
2. **Calculate your target range**:
    - Bottom line: The minimum you'll accept
    - Target: Your ideal number based on research and value
    - Stretch: An optimistic but justifiable figure

During the Negotiation:

1. Let them make the first offer.
    - If asked about expectations earlier, you can say "I would like to learn more about the role and total compensation package before discussing numbers".
2. When receiving the offer:
    - Express enthusiasm about the role and company
    - Thank them for the offer
    - Ask for time to review it (24-48 hours is standard)

Example: "Thank you for the offer. I am excited about the opportunity to join **[Company]**. Would it be alright if I took 24 hours to review the details?"

3. When countering:
    - Start by reiterating your interest
    - Highlight your specific value and qualifications
    - Present your counter with confidence

Example: I have really enjoyed learning about the role and am confident I can bring significant value to the team. Based on my experience with **[relevant skils]** and the market rate for similar positions, I was hoping we could discuss a base salary of **[your target number]**

4. Consider the total package:
    - Base salary
    - Bonus potential
    - Equity/stock options
    - Benefits

- Professional development
- Work flexibility

Key Tips:

- Always negotiate respectfully and professionally
- Focus on your value and contributions, not personal needs
- Got the final offer in writing
- Consider negotiating multiple elements, not just salary
- Be prepared to walk away if the offer doesn't meet your minimum requirements

Red Flags to Watch For:

- Pressure to accept immediately
- Reluctance to put things in writing
- Vague promises about future raises

If they say yes to your counter, great! If not, stay professional and work toward a middle ground that satisfies both parties.

Salary Negotiation Conversation:

HR: "Hi Piyush, I'm pleased to offer you the Senior Software Engineer position at TechCorp. Based on your experience and our discussions, we'd like to offer you a base salary of $130,000 annually along with our standard benefits package."

Candidate: "Thank you for the offer. I am genuinely excited about the opportunity to join TechCorp. I've been really impressed with the team and the company's vision. Would you mind if I took a day to review all the details?"

HR: "Of course, take your time. Please let me know if you have any questions."

[Next day]

Candidate [SDET]: "Thanks for giving me time to review. I really appreciate the offer and am enthusiastic about contributing to TechCorp. Based on my seven years of experience leading test automation initiatives and my track record of reducing regression testing cycles by 60% through implementing robust CI/CD pipelines at my current company, I was hoping to discuss the compensation package. I've also successfully built test frameworks from scratch using

Selenium, TestNG, and Rest Assured that increased test coverage by 85%, and implemented performance testing solutions using JMeter that caught critical bottlenecks before production. Given the current market rates for senior SDETs with my expertise in automation, CI/CD and performance testing, would you be open to a base salary of $155,000?"

Candidate [SDE]: "Thanks for giving me time to review. I really appreciate the offer and am enthusiastic about contributing to TechCorp. Based on my decade of experience leading cloud infrastructure projects and my track record of reducing deployment times by 40% at my current company, I was hoping to discuss the compensation package. Given the current market rates for senior engineers with my specialized skills in AWS and Kubernetes, would you be open to a base salary of $155,000?"

Highlights SDET-specific achievements (test automation, CICD implementation) Provides concrete metrics (60% reduction in testing cycles, 85% increase in coverage) Names specific relevant technologies (Selenium, TestNG, Rest Assured, JMeter) Shows both technical depth and business impact Maintains the same professional and confident tone while being specific to the SDET role.

HR: “I understand your position, but $155,000 is above our initial budget for this role. However, I can see the value you'd bring, especially with your cloud infrastructure experience. We might be able to go up to 140,000".

Candidate: "I appreciate you considering an increase. Given my expertise in areas directly aligned with your upcoming cloud migration project, and considering I've successfully led three similar migrations, I believe I can make an immediate impact. Would it be possible to meet in the middle at $148,000? I am also interested in discussing the equity package structure."

HR: "Let me discuss this with the hiring manager. [After some time] We can do $145,000 base salary, and I can increase the equity grant from 200 to 300 restricted stock units. We can also guarantee a performance review in 6 months instead of the standard annual review."

Candidate: "That sounds very promising. Could you send me the complete package details in writing, including the equity vesting schedule and the 6-month review terms? Once I review those, I think we can move forward.”

HR: "Absolutely I will send that over today. We're excited to have you join us!"

Key elements that made this negotiation successful:

- The candidate remained professional and enthusiastic throughout
- They backed up their request with specific achievements and skills
- They considered the total package, not just salary
- They got everything in writing
- They used silence strategically and didn't rush
- They focused on value to the company rather than personal needs
- They negotiated multiple elements (salary, equity, review timeline)
- They stayed positive and collaborative, not adversarial